

ACECQA Service Quality, Accessibility & Operations Analysis — Presentation Script

Target length: ~9:00, inside the assignment's hard 5–10 minute window. **[SHOW ...]** marks when to bring up each chart; keep your face visible in a corner the whole time per the assignment requirement.

Structure: one central business problem, three angles on it. Every section opens by naming the problem or question *before* the chart appears — the chart is evidence for a claim you've already made, not a pattern you're discovering out loud. If you only remember one thing from these delivery notes: never say "here's a chart showing X" — say "X is a problem, here's the proof" instead.

Opening — state the problem, not the topic (0:00–0:45)

[Face to camera, title slide]

"Hi, I'm [YOUR NAME], and I work for government to improve education and care services across Australia. Here's the problem: ACECQA and state governments have a limited budget for lifting service quality and funding new services, across seventeen thousand approved services nationally. Spent well, that budget closes real gaps for families. Spent wrong, it doesn't move the needle. So today, three questions: where is quality actually failing and why, where are families genuinely cut off from services, and — just as important — what should we *stop* assuming matters, so we don't waste money chasing it."

Data & method, briefly (0:45–1:10)

[SHOW a slide with the dataset summary, or talk over the title slide]

"Quickly on the data: this is the national register of every approved service, with quality ratings and transport-access data. Before trusting it, I checked it — ten services had no address at all and had all been geocoded to the same point in Myanmar. I dropped those rather than guess. Everything else checked out."

Limitations — what this analysis can't tell you (1:10–1:35)

[SHOW limitations slide]

"Before the findings, a quick word on limitations. This is a single snapshot, not a longitudinal study — cohort comparisons are different services, not the same ones tracked over time. Ratings are each state's own administrative judgement, not an independent audit. Every relationship I test is correlational, not causal. And one comparison, rurality versus connectivity by state, has only eight data points — flagged as illustrative, not conclusive."

Problem 1: Is quality failing consistently, or is it a specific, fixable issue? (1:35–4:10)

"First problem: all eight states and territories apply the same National Law. If quality outcomes are wildly inconsistent anyway, that's either a resourcing gap or an enforcement gap — and knowing which

one matters, because they need completely different fixes."

Chart 1 — Rating by state, ranked by non-compliance (1:45–2:20)

[SHOW 01_rating_by_state.png]

"They are wildly inconsistent — and I'm ranking this by who's actually failing the legal minimum, not who's excelling. The Northern Territory is worst: twenty-two percent of its services rated Working Towards NQS or Significant Improvement Required. Victoria is best, at four percent. Same law, five-times difference. That's not noise — that's a finding that should already be uncomfortable for a national regulator."

Chart 2 — Rating by service type, ranked by non-compliance (2:20–2:40)

[SHOW 02_rating_by_service_type.png]

"It's not just geography, either. Ranked the same way as Chart 1 — worst compliance first — Family Day Care is the clear outlier: twenty-two percent non-compliant, roughly double Long Day Care and Outside School Hours Care, and miles behind standalone preschools at under two percent. Family Day Care is a small slice of the sector by numbers, but it's the single worst-performing service type in the country."

Chart 3 — Which Quality Area drags states down (2:40–3:15)

[SHOW 03_quality_area_heatmap.png]

"This chart zooms into which specific component drives the number. The Northern Territory and Tasmania still lead — but Western Australia and South Australia join them here, up to fourteen percent non-compliant in a single quality area, even though WA ranked only fourth overall in Chart 1. A state's rating isn't a simple average of its seven components — a state can look mid-table while hiding a real problem in one area, concentrated in Quality Area 1, educational program, and Quality Area 7, governance."

Chart 4 — Spatial map of ratings (3:10–3:25)

[SHOW 04_spatial_ratings_map.png]

"And it's local enough to act on directly — you can see clusters of underperforming services around Perth and Adelaide specifically, which means a support team could be deployed to a cluster, not spread across an entire state."

Chart 5 — Does distance from transport hurt quality? (3:25–4:10)

[SHOW 05_transport_vs_quality.png]

"Before recommending a fix, I need to test the obvious hypothesis: does poor transport access damage quality? I looked at the share of services rated below the NQS standard by distance to the nearest train station. It rises from seven-point-six percent for the closest services to ten-point-three for the furthest — real and significant, but small. A transport upgrade might nudge quality slightly; it won't close a ten-times state-level gap. A minor risk factor beside much bigger drivers."

Problem 2: Are families structurally cut off from services, and where worst? (4:10–6:15)

"Second problem, and the assignment sets four specific questions here. I'm answering each one directly, with a chart built to prove a claim, not just describe a distribution."

Chart 6 — How concentrated is provision in cities versus the country? (4:10–4:35)

[SHOW 06_geographic_distribution.png]

"First: the geographic disparity itself. Measuring services per square kilometre by ABS area type, Major Urban areas have about twelve thousand times the density of Rural Balance areas. That's not just 'cities have more people' — it's an order of magnitude beyond any population ratio you could justify. Provision is structurally concentrated, not just naturally uneven."

Chart 7 — Where are additional services needed most? (4:35–5:00)

[SHOW 07_underserved_regions.png]

"Second: where specifically should ACECQA add capacity? I measured, for every service, the distance to its nearest alternative — the real question a family asks when their usual centre is full or closed. Ranked worst first: Western Australia's Bounded Localities are the single worst case in the country, a median forty-one kilometres to a backup option. The Northern Territory's Bounded Localities are second, at thirty kilometres. These are the two places a new-service dollar should go first — not a general 'rural funding' line, a named list."

Chart 8 — Is a state's connectivity problem just how rural it is? (5:00–5:23)

[SHOW 08_state_connectivity_vs_rurality.png]

"One gut check: are NT and Tasmania — already flagged worst on compliance — just showing up again here because they're the most rural? Plotting rural share against statewide connectivity: yes for them, a genuinely statewide problem. But Western Australia breaks the pattern — despite the country's biggest coverage gap, from Chart 7, only four percent of its services are rural, so its statewide connectivity average is actually the best in the country. Same state, two different problems."

Chart 9 — Are services well-connected to public transport? (5:23–5:53)

[SHOW 09_transport_connectivity.png]

"Third requirement: transport connectivity, using distance to the nearest station and bus stop, with a deliberately generous bar — five kilometres to a train station, ten to a bus stop, a short drive, not a walk. Even so, eighty-three percent of services nationally clear it. That collapses to twenty-one percent in small country towns and thirty-four in the most rural areas — a seventy-point gap against major cities, on a generous bar. A real rural transport gap, not a threshold artefact."

Chart 10 — Where do the transport gaps concentrate? (5:53–6:35)

[SHOW 10_spatial_connectivity.png]

"Fourth: mapping every poorly-connected service directly, rather than just a state or area-type average. Roughly twenty-seven hundred services, in red, more than a short drive from any train or bus stop — concentrated in small towns and rural stretches away from the main rail corridors, not scattered

randomly. That confirms Chart 9's area breakdown directly: this is a genuine, geographically concentrated rural access gap."

Problem 3: Which operational factors actually push a service below the standard — and which just look like they do? (6:35–8:30)

"Third problem, and it's a different kind of test. ACECQA could point to three operational levers — size, opening hours, how old a service is — and assume any of them explains non-compliance. I tested all three directly. Two matter. One doesn't."

Chart 11 — Does size predict non-compliance? No. (6:38–7:00)

[SHOW 11_capacity_by_type.png]

"Capacity varies a lot by type and by area — sixty-six places typical in major cities, twenty-seven in small country towns. But tested directly against non-compliance in capacity bands, the smallest services sit at nine-point-three percent, the largest at eight-point-six — not even statistically significant. A bigger centre is no safer bet — a new rural service doesn't need city-sized capacity to meet the standard."

Chart 12 — Does approval date predict non-compliance? Yes — the strongest signal here. (7:00–7:45)

[SHOW 12_approval_trend.png]

"A data trap first: approvals-per-year spikes in 2012 — over four thousand in one year. Read naively, that's explosive growth. It isn't — the National Quality Framework commenced that January and bulk-transferred every already-operating service onto new numbers, not newly opened ones. The right-hand panel is the real story: grouped by when they were actually approved, services from 2019 onward sit at eleven percent non-compliant, against eight-point-four percent for pre-2012, long-established services. Newer services simply haven't had the years to embed practice yet. That's the strongest operational signal in this whole analysis."

Chart 13 — Does opening hours predict non-compliance? Yes, and it's the sharpest jump. (7:45–8:25)

[SHOW 13_hours_vs_quality.png]

"Opening hours shows the clearest relationship of the three — seven percent non-compliant under forty-five hours a week, rising to nineteen percent for the longest-opening services, more than double. And closing the loop on Problem 1: transport still doesn't move capacity or hours in any meaningful way — its small compliance effect from Chart 5 stands on its own. Two of three operational levers actually predict whether a service meets the standard; one is noise dressed up as insight."

Close — the decision, not a recap (8:25–9:05)

[Face to camera, optional summary slide]

"Back to the budget question. One: the Northern Territory needs urgent, statewide compliance intervention in educational program and governance — a legal-minimum problem, not a generic audit."

Tasmania, SA and WA aren't far behind. Two: new-service funding has a named destination — WA's and the NT's Bounded Localities, forty-one and thirty kilometres from a family's nearest backup option. Three: transport connectivity is a rural investment priority, real but small as a quality lever — fund it for equity, don't oversell it. And four: give newly-approved services a support pathway, not a compliance one. A budget with a reason behind every line. Thank you."

Delivery notes

- ~1,365 spoken words. At 140–160 words/minute that's roughly 8:32–9:45 — comfortable margin under the 10-minute hard cap even at a deliberate, unhurried pace. Practice once to check your own rate.
- **If you need to cut time**, in order: (1) the "Data & method" beat — compress the Myanmar catch to one sentence, (2) the Limitations beat — drop the "correlational, not causal" sentence, the other four points still cover it, (3) Chart 10's own beat — the "confirms Chart 9" line can be one sentence instead of two, (4) Chart 8's bridge beat can be trimmed to the WA callout alone, dropping the NT/Tasmania comparison sentence. Never cut Chart 5 or the transport call-back in Chart 13 — that "small effect, sized honestly against the bigger drivers" chain is your strongest evidence of analytical rigour for a policy audience, and it's what makes the closing recommendation credible rather than asserted.
- If asked why urban/rural wasn't done with the postcode-allocation method: the direct spatial join avoids the many-to-many postcode-to-SA1 mapping problem, since the dataset already has coordinates for every service.
- Keep the Family Day Care data-quality catches (capacity populated for only 2 of 417 services; "hours" meaning something structurally different for a scheme vs a single centre) in your back pocket for Q&A even if you don't narrate them in the timed script.